PROSE-DENSITY CONTRACT

Budget the words.

Every layout declares how many words each element gets — so the author writes tight, and the reviewer flags the wall of text before it ships.

The right layout, with far too many words.

Wrong shape

Phase 1 already steers which layout, and how many elements.

Right shape, wrong words

Each card carries a paragraph, not a clause.

The result

The slide overflows, and the room stops reading.

KEY INSIGHT

Count is solved. Density is the verbosity left over once the count is right.

Two budgets, one axis.

Capacity

How many elements fit — `~4 cards`, past which the grid crowds.

Density

How many words each element gets — `~15`, past which it overflows.

Together

Pick the layout by shape; write each element to its word budget.

How the numbers are set.

STEP 01

Seed the target

The aim comes from the canon — a label, not a sentence.

STEP 02

Clamp the ceiling

Render at rising word counts; read where it actually overflows.

STEP 03

Keep the gap

The target sits well below the break — good taste.

Each row gets a word budget too.

Owns the scoring model — Head of Product

One short responsibility, not a job description.

Runs the weekly review — Chief of Staff

A clause per row keeps the ledger scannable.

Maintains the log — Program Manager

Detail belongs on a follow-up slide, not here.

The chrome has budgets, regardless of layout.

Eyebrow ≤ 5 words

A label that frames, not a sentence that explains.

Title and subtitle ≤ 10 · ≤ 12

The takeaway lands in one tight line.

Key insight and pill ≤ 18 · ≤ 2

One memorable sentence; a one-word status chip.

Write tight; the reviewer has your back.

`components.json` *carries each layout's* `density`*; the Studio's Coach flags an overrun as a suggestion. We recommend writing to the budget up front — that, not the warning, is the real fix.*